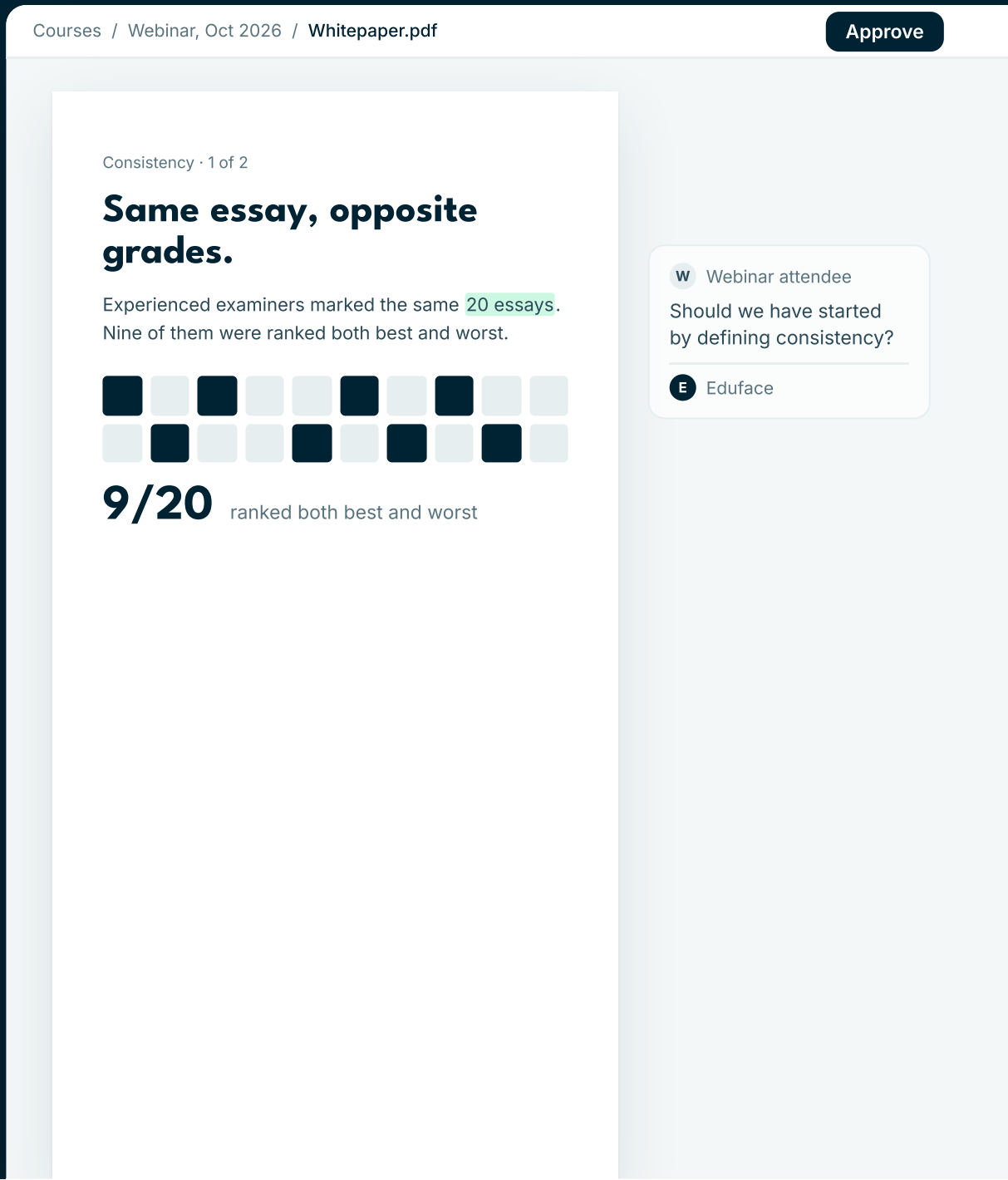
Whitepaper · October 2026

The business outcomes of AI marking and feedback

Consistency and operational efficiency, from 20+ implementations.

Eduface



Two outcomes, from 20+ implementations.

Institutions bring in AI marking and feedback for many reasons. The results we can measure come down to two: consistency and operational efficiency.

Consistency pages 3 to 4

Students are judged on their work, not on who marked it.

Definition

Every paper is marked against the same criteria in the same way: the same mark, the same focus and the same style of feedback, whoever marks it.

9/20 essays ranked both best and worst by experienced examiners

Operational efficiency pages 5 to 6

Lecturer time moves from typing feedback to teaching.

Definition

Less staff time per assignment for the same or better feedback, while the lecturer still approves every comment and every mark.

−85% time spent typing feedback, up to 20 minutes per assignment

W Webinar attendee

Should we have started this conversation by defining consistency?

E Eduface

Yes. So that is where this paper starts.

Consistency · 1 of 2

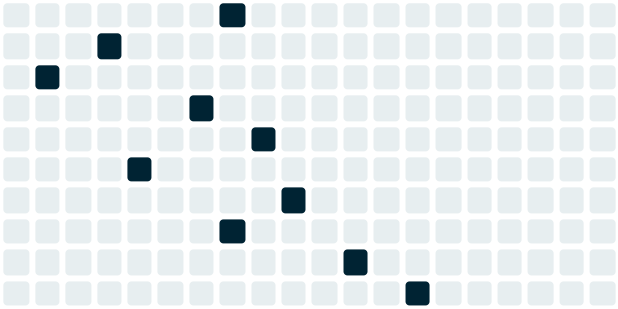
Eduface

Same essay, opposite grades.

24 experienced examiners from 20 UK universities marked the same 20 essays. Nine were ranked among both the best and the worst. Moderation is meant to catch this, but it only sees a sample.



9/20 essays ranked both best and worst



10/200 papers a typical moderation sample sees (illustration)

Many markers, one module

Each marker reads the rubric a little differently.

Paper 80 is not paper 5

The same marker marks the eightieth paper differently from the fifth.

Moderation sees a sample

The other papers are never compared.

Bloxham et al., Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education, 2016.

W Webinar attendee

Students worry whether they get the same marks for saying the same things as peers who were marked by someone else.

E Eduface

This is consistency as students feel it.

W Webinar attendee

Why should complete consistency be the ideal in an activity that relies on expert judgement?

E Eduface

It shouldn't be. Consistency means the same criteria are applied. Markers can still disagree, and now you can see where they do.

Consistency · 2 of 2

Eduface

Every paper read. No AI grade shown.

Not ready for AI grades? The consistency check reads every paper in the background and flags marks outside the expected range. The marker keeps the mark, and the AI grade stays hidden.

Submission	Your mark	AI grade	Consistency signal
#1042	65	Hidden	–
#1043	58	Hidden	–
#1044	72	Hidden	–
#1045	41	Hidden	▲ Outside expected range
#1046	67	Hidden	–

A spreadsheet

Compares marks with marks.

A 41 looks low next to a 65. It can't tell if the paper deserved it.

The consistency check

Compares the mark with the paper.

A 41 on a weak paper stays quiet. A 41 on a strong paper gets flagged.

W Webinar attendee

Is AI needed to find the grades outside the expected range? Is it better and more accurate than Excel?

E Eduface

Excel only sees the numbers. The check reads the work behind them.

W Webinar attendee

Doesn't optimising for consistency remove the diversity of viewpoints moderation is meant to provide?

E Eduface

No viewpoint is removed. Moderators get pointed to the papers where views split.

Illustrative screen, fictional data.

Bad AI feedback costs more time than no AI.

Fixing inaccurate feedback is slower than writing your own. Accuracy is the business case, and tuning the model to your rubric is the investment that pays for it.



Time per assignment. Illustration, not a measurement.

94%

average accuracy, 435 submissions and 13 markers

98%

for markers who tuned the model to their rubric

−85%

time spent typing feedback, up to 20 minutes per assignment

W Webinar attendee

Could or should we trust the statistical probability of an AI model?

E Eduface

Not blindly. Measure it against your own markers first. That is what these numbers are.

Accuracy is how close the AI's grade proposal is to the marker's own grade, on average. It is not a match rate. Accuracy measured in one of our implementations, typing time across our implementations.

Operational efficiency · 2 of 2

Eduface

The AI drafts. The lecturer decides.

Time is saved on writing, not on judging. Nothing reaches the student without the lecturer, and every edit is logged.

AI drafts
A comment per rubric criterion

→

Lecturer decides
Approves, edits or adds

→

Student receives
Only approved feedback

97%

of summative assignments get extra feedback from the lecturer, on top of the AI draft. Lecturers don't outsource their judgement.

A nudge against rubber-stamping



After a long run of drafts approved untouched, the platform asks the lecturer a question about one specific assignment.

W Webinar attendee

Our students have explicitly said they don't want AI involved in marking and feedback.

W Webinar attendee

Students might be prepared to do this in partnership.

E Eduface

Agreed. Students only ever see feedback their lecturer approved.

Edit rate: Eduface implementations.

Next step

Eduface

Start with one module.

Pick the outcome that matters most to you, test it on one module, and measure it against how you work today.

Route 1

Consistency first

Run the consistency check on a module you already marked. No AI grade is shown to anyone.

Route 2

Efficiency first

Give AI-drafted feedback on one assignment, tuned to your rubric and approved by the lecturer.

Measure	Measure	Measure
Moderation flags	**Marking hours per assignment**	**Feedback turnaround**

Choose your module in 30 minutes.

A short call to pick the route and the module.

eduface.me

W Webinar attendee

I'm sure there is something to investigate here, but it's not straightforward.

E Eduface

Agreed. That is why we start with one module.